GAME PITCH

Elemanental

Every shot is a read.

A 1v1 top-down shooter/fighter where four elemental duelists trade projectiles, parries and dashes.

Project 5 · AET 330T AI Explorations, Fall 2026



Four duelists, six actions, no safe answer

Earth, Fire, Water and Air fight on a single-screen platform. Win a round by knock out, ring out or time out, and take the match in best of five.

Easy to start, hard to master

Anyone can shoot and dash in the first match. Skill comes from reads, parry timing and stamina.

Rock–paper–scissors at every exchange

Every action wins two matchups and loses two, with two exceptions.

Readable at a glance

Element, shield state and stamina show in color and silhouette alone.

Six actions, each wins two and loses two

Action	Category	Beats	Loses to
Light shot	Offense	Parry, Dash	Shield, Rush
Heavy shot	Offense	Shield, Rush	Parry, Dash
Shield	Defense	Light shot	Heavy shot, Rush
Parry	Defense	Heavy shot, Rush	Light shot, Dash
Dash	Movement	Heavy shot, Parry	Light shot
Rush	Movement	Light shot, Shield	Heavy shot, Parry

Shield wins only one matchup, so it is the safe default. Dash loses only one but costs stamina and deals no damage.

Four elements, four playstyles

Earth · The Anchor

Slow and heavy. Rock walls pull opponents in; Absorb stores blocked shots. Cannot parry.

Fire · The Aggressor

Light shots build Burn. A heavy shot or rush detonates it into damage.

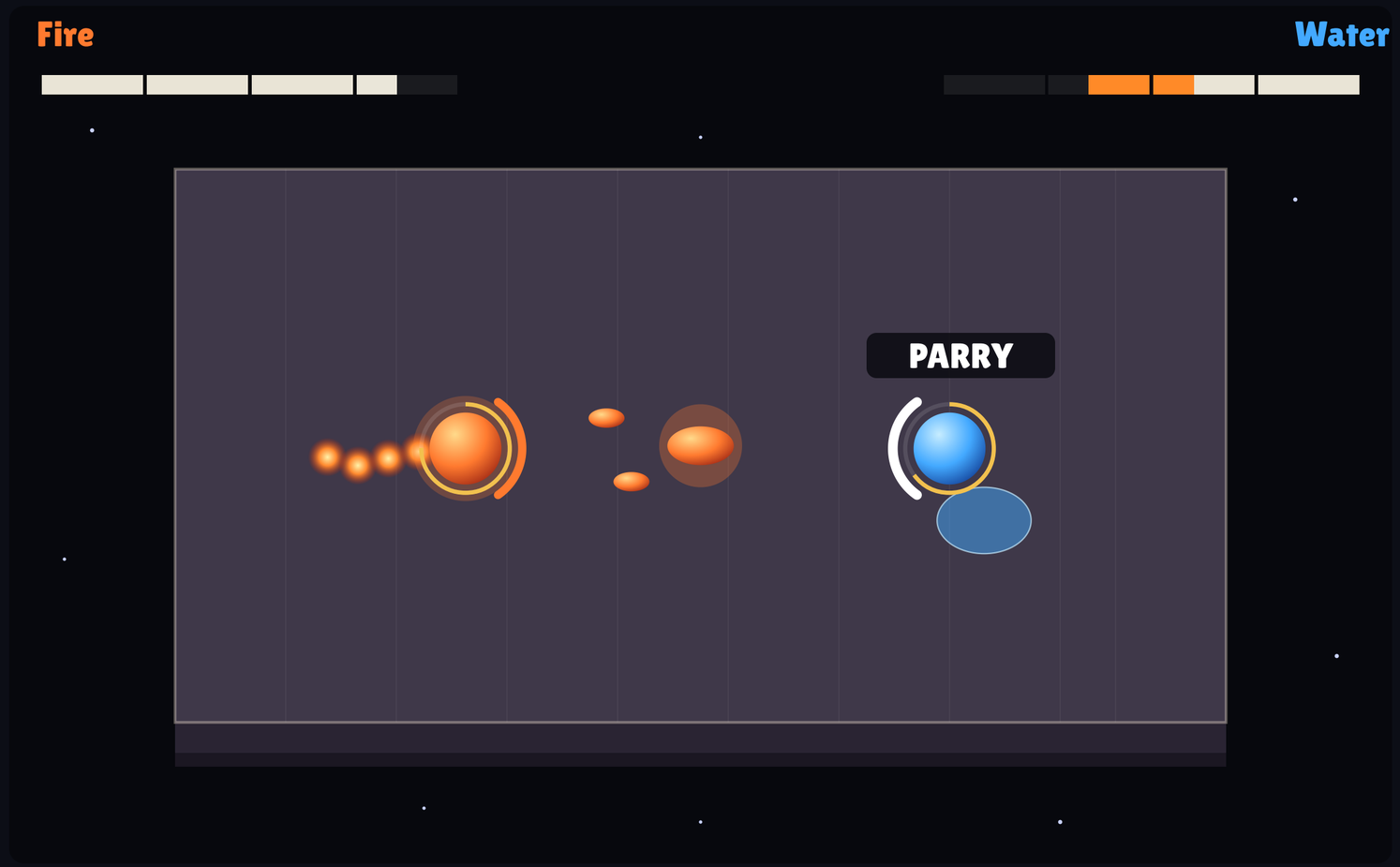
Water · The Counter-Puncher

Biggest parry window. Parried shots return with extra knockback; chain dashes leave slick ground.

Air · The Trickster

Homing stream, farthest dash. Mimic copies the shot it parries, effects included.

Playable now: the Fire vs. Water prototype



WHAT IT PROVES

- All six actions and the full matchup chart
- Stamina, winded state, ring outs
- Fire: Burn and Detonate
- Water: parry, redirect, slick ground

Local 1v1 against a CPU or a gamepad, best of 5.

Open the prototype

How a match is won

Knock out

Reduce the opponent's health to 0. About four clean hits end a round.

Ring out

Knock the opponent off the platform. Knockback grows as health drops.

Time out

After 60 seconds, more health wins. A tie goes to sudden death.

Stamina is the budget. Offense is free; defense and movement cost stamina. At zero you are winded for 1.5 seconds.

Best of five. Matches last 3–5 minutes. The loser of a round switches element or picks the next map.

Who it is for, and how it should feel

PLAYERS

Competitive and arcade players

People who enjoy PvP, fighting games and arcade games, playing local 1v1 on a Windows PC.

- Readable at a glance
- Learnable in one match
- Short enough to rematch

NOTICE

No action is safe against everything, and each element plays differently.

FEEL

The tension of reading an opponent, and the payoff of a clean parry or ring out.

BE ABLE TO

Shoot and dash in the first match, then improve through timing, stamina and matchups.

Color-coded spheres, shapes you can read



Earth

Chunky rocks



Fire

Streaks



Water

Droplets



Air

Thin crescents

3D top-down camera, gameplay on a flat plane. Characters are simple spheres with element shaders. Backup: 2D pixel art.

What the system does, and what it runs on

Matchup system
Six actions with a full win/lose chart, plus a stamina budget.

Health and knockback
Four-segment health, knockback that grows as health drops, ring outs.

Four element kits
Per-element values and special mechanics, each with its own shader.

Rounds and local play
Best of five, sudden death, two players on one PC.

STACK · BUILT FROM SCRATCH

Unity **URP** **C#** **Input System**
Shader Graph **ScriptableObjects**
Windows build

Every balance number lives in a ScriptableObject, so tuning stays fast.

The challenge I am taking on: keep four asymmetric kits balanced and readable on screen at once.

The MVP: Fire vs. Water, one arena

INCLUDES

- All six actions and the matchup chart
- Stamina and the winded state
- Segmented health and knockback
- Ring out, time out, best of five
- Local 1v1 with simple shapes

IT WORKS WHEN

- ✓ Two people can play a full best-of-five match
- ✓ Parry, burn and detonate behave as designed
- ✓ It runs at 60 FPS

Five weeks, four elements

PHASE 1

Oct 26–Nov 2

Pitch.

PHASE 2

Nov 2–9

MVP: six actions, stamina, health, Fire vs. Water.

PHASE 3

Nov 9–16

Rounds, Earth kit, Fire, Water and Earth shaders.

PHASE 4

Nov 16–30

Air kit and shader, arenas, menus, audio, peer review.

PHASE 5

Nov 30–Dec 7

Balance, fixes, juice, final build.

Nov 9 milestone check

Nov 30 peer review

Dec 7 public Windows build

Risks and stretch goals

RISKS, AND HOW I WILL FIND OUT EARLY

Balance across four kits
Playtest the MVP with another person in Phase 2

All four elements in five weeks
Decide at the end of Phase 3 whether Air is cut

Air's Mimic interactions
Build Air last

Visual clutter on screen
Readability rules and a one-wall cap, checked in the MVP

Shader time
First shader early in Phase 3; pixel art is the last resort

STRETCH GOALS, IN ORDER

1. Arenas with hazards
2. 2v2 mode
3. Genji-Ball variant

Decision requested: approve either Elemanental or Plane Shift to begin Phase 2 on Nov 2.